# Project Templates - Product Requirements Document | Prepared by Marcus Webb

## Summary

Admins setting up a new Nexus project repeat the same work every time: the same task lists, the same starter docs, the same role setup. Project Templates lets an admin create a project from a template, and save an existing project as a template, so a team's proven setup becomes the starting point instead of a blank page. This document covers the first version.

## Problem

In the day-30 onboarding survey, setup time is the most common stall point new admins name, and workspace admins who start from a blank project invite their first teammate later than admins who copy an existing project. Teams have asked for templates in support conversations for two quarters. The full problem statement is a separate document (Problem Statement: New admins stall before their first invitation).

## Goals

| Goal | Success Metric |
| --- | --- |
| Shorten time from workspace creation to a working project | Median time from signup to a project with 5 or more tasks falls from 3 days to 1 day within two quarters of launch |
| Raise first-month activation for new workspaces | More new admins invite a teammate in their first week |
| Make proven setups reusable | At least 25% of new projects are created from a template within six months of launch |

## Scope

In scope:

- Creating a project from a template: tasks (with relative due dates), docs, and default member roles
- Saving an existing project as a template, within the same workspace
- Five starter templates written by the Nexus team (product launch, sprint starter, content calendar, hiring pipeline, event plan)

Out of scope:

- A public template gallery or marketplace
- Automations inside templates (a later version)
- Templates for docs outside projects

## Requirements

| # | Requirement | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| R1 | An admin can create a project from any template they can access, in no more steps than creating a blank project takes today plus one | Template picker appears in the new-project flow |
| R2 | Creating from a template copies its tasks, docs, and default role assignments; relative due dates shift to the creation date | Member assignments are copied as roles, not as named people |
| R3 | An admin can save a project they administer as a template, choosing which parts to include | Tasks, docs, and roles are independently optional |
| R4 | A template can be edited after creation without changing projects already made from it | Projects are copies, not links |
| R5 | The template picker will be a modal with a swipeable carousel of template cards, each with a preview image | Design has the carousel pattern from the mobile homepage work |
| R6 | Templates should feel fast to create from | Test with the five starter templates before launch |
| R7 | An admin can submit a template to the community gallery from the template's menu | Gallery moderation is owned by the community team |

## Dependencies

- The permissions update (roles as project defaults) must ship first; templates store default roles in its format.
- The new-project flow is owned by the onboarding team, whose current sprint ends November 6, 2026.

## Open Questions

- Whether templates can include member assignments by name before the permissions update ships. TBD.
- Whether a copied doc keeps its comments. Proposed: no, comments do not copy.

- Pricing: whether templates are a Pro feature or available on all plans. Decision needed from the pricing review on November 10, 2026.

## Timeline

| Milestone | Date |
|---|---|
| Requirements freeze | October 30, 2026 |
| Build complete | November 20, 2026 |
| Launch to all workspaces | December 4, 2026 |